

History of the Empire

- 40000 The Elders are practicing **Old Magic**. Their society is agrarian but not very highly developed. They are found exclusively on the main continent of the Empire, which the Elders call **Avilund**.
- 35000 The Elder society is prominently urban by this time. They begin to develop **New Magic**.
- 33500 The Elders are masters of New Magic by this time. Their society sees it's first major troubles, as Old Magic factions rival New Magic factions for rulership of their society, though no open wars are fought.
- 30000 The **Pentaganent Elders** (Old Magic faction) breed the first Ferals (**Pentadaaman**), anticipating that the **Decaganent** (New Magic faction) will begin to wage war.
- 28500 The Pentaganent Elders foresee that the Decaganents will destroy them, and so they leave the main continent. They breed another race of Ferals (**Decadaaman**) that they leave behind on Avilund in order to cause the Decaganents trouble.
- 28500-14000 For this long period of history, the two Elder societies develop independent of each other. The Pentaganents continue the use of Old Magic, and use the Pentadaaman as slaves.
- The Decaganents develop a very sophisticated society on Avilund, despite constant warring with the Decadaaman. They master New Magic, which they use to build their society.
- 14000 The Pentaganents encounter modern man for the first time, on the Island of Daaman. They speculate that men are a sub-race of Pentadaaman that evolved independent of their influence. The Pentaganents befriend them, and teach them Old Magic. The Pentaganents give this race the name **Odopentadaaman**.
- 8000-6500 **Age of Infestation** (*I want this to be the equivalent of our 'Flood Myth', if you don't mind*). A global infestation of giant spiders. The spiders have magic and power greater than the Elders, and the two factions are forced to join together in order to combat them. This age ends with a relative containment of the Infestation.
- 6500-3000 **Age of Atrophy**. The Elder societies, spent from their wars with the spiders (we will come up with a good name for them...creative portion of my brain is not awake at this time...), begin to decline.

The Pentadaaman on Avilund begin to overrun the Pentagonent cities, while in remote parts, the Decadaaman and the Odopentadaaman ('Man', for short) begin to edge out the Decaganents, though without the overt warlike tactics of the Pentadaaman.

- 3000 The Odopentadaaman begin to develop **Middle Magic** which springs from Ancestor Worship. The names of these original ancestors that were worshiped at this time are forgotten. At this time, the society of Man is primarily a Hunter-Gatherer, nomadic society. They left many stone cairns and other rock carvings and simple, crude structures.
- 2000 The Pentagonets are reduced to only two cities; Waldheim and Vermillund. The Decaganents are reduced to a few small villages and towns. None of their cities remain, as the Decadaaman and Man have edged them out to all but the most remote parts.
- 1582 Birth of Rivenghast of the Isle of Vander
- 1580 Birth of Gaulghast. The 3333rd anniversary of this event is 3 years away, as many doomsday cults fear.
- 1560 Riven marries Ruth.
- 1550 This is a year of ruin for Riven. Gaul, who covets Ruth, does a series of terrible deeds in this year, in order to break them apart.

First, he slaughters their children. He thinks he has killed all 4, but in fact, Mairin stole away with Severinius, exchanging her own child in order to fool Gaul. Though a tragedy of great proportions, it is Mairin, rather than Riven, that gets blamed for this evil act, contrary to Gaul's best attempt to frame his brother.

Next, he rapes and murders his sister, Muriel. He successfully frames his brother for this misdeed, and Ruth turns her back on Riven.

Riven appeals to his father, who believes him. When Gaul finds out that his father will attempt to clear Riven's name of this foul act, he kills his father too. Gaul is also able to frame Riven for the murder of their father.

Riven is made a criminal, and is forced to flee for his life. He will spend the next 33 years wandering the wilderness.

Some theological scholars believe that Gaul made his pact with the Devils in this year. The 3333rd anniversary of this event is 33 years away.

- 1517 Riven returns to the Isle of Vander to confront his brother and prove his innocence. Before confronting his brother, he makes amends with Ruth, and the two are once again joined as husband and wife. Unfortunately for Riven, Gaul learns of his brother's return and has time to plot again. He manages to use powerful magic to bind the two of them helpless. He forces Riven to watch as he rapes and kills Ruth.

This is too much for Riven to bear. He breaks free of his magical bindings, and engages his brother in deadly combat. The two fight for a length of time that is disputed in theological scholarly circles; some say 3 days, some say 33, some 333. At any rate, the two transcend this world, though whether by mutual mortal death, or some greater magical transcendence, is unknown.

Later in the year, Mairin returns with Severinius, who claims rulership of the clan.

- 1505 Severinius has brought unity to the whole of the Isle of Vander. In this year, he weds the Angel, Ida, and they have their first child, Dunstan.

- 1504 Birth of Sebald. Sebald is very long-lived, and it is he who is probably most responsible for the spread of Man and the development of Man's culture.

- 1503 Severinius claims to have many conversations with his father, who describes his continued struggles with Gaul, and his long journey through the Valley of Death. Severinius claims in this year that it is his father, alone, that should be consulted on matters of faith. This is a new concept to the people of the Isle of Vander. Severinius is often seen with his friends (some say 'Disciples') Caspar and Caanan. His relationship with these men is a thing of mystery. Both seem to be personalities that he would be at odds with, but he remains fast friends with them until his death.

- 1400 The church of the Prime Saint has grown to a substantial size, and brought prosperity to its people. Sebald, through many consultations with the few remaining Elders, has helped to bring the culture of Man to great heights in only a short time. They are excellent stone-masons, ship builders, cultivators and horticulturalists in many areas. This year marks the journey of

Sebald and Barnabas from Vander in the vessel known in legend as *Bram'Cairn*, a controversially Kellish name meaning 'without burial'. This ship is in a remarkable state of preservation in a great stone warehouse in Vanderwail.

-1250 This is a momentous year. It is heralded as the true birth of the church. In this year, Sebald is said to have gotten word from his grandfather that he had found his way to Heaven, and that his evil brother had found his way to Hell. It is suspected that Gaul signed his pact with the Devils in this year, and that Riven was made the Ruler of Heaven. This date is the Orthodox birth date of the Primus Deus Fidelis. The first stones at Vanderwail are laid this year as well. The 3333rd anniversary of this even is 333 years away.

-1250-450 **First Age of Imperial Expansion;** The descendants of Riven prosper on the mainland. They are constantly at war with the Ferals, but manage to push back their boundaries more with each century. They are settled mostly in the south (in the regions around Vanderwail and the modern-day city of Lysander), but covet the resource-rich north, especially the river valleys of the Wen and Nith. At the intersection of these two rivers is the fabled city of Waldheim, where the Pentaganet culture is said to have peaked. At this time, the Ferals occupy Waldheim. A series of wars makes this place change hands not only between the Men of the Empire and the Ferals, but also the Norlunders who occupy the far north (much later on in this period; the Norlunders did not appear on these shores until sometime around -650).

By -450, the great castle Vanderwail is as massive and sprawling as it is today, though it is packed with thousands of Men. The city of Tiberwail (modern day Lysander) is well established, and the modern day road that connects them is even more populous and well protected than it is today. Trade and communications flow between these two great establishments fast and frequently.

Also by -450, the pantheon of Saints numbers over 100, and there are no less than 6 great cathedrals (only one of which survives to this day; The Cathedral of St. Dunstan in Lysander) outside of Vanderwail.

-450 **Invasion of Brogard The Cruel;** In this year, a horde of Ferals under the leadership of Brogard the Cruel, numbering over 100,000, marches upon the southern Empire of Man. Tiberwail is razed nearly to the ground, and the settlements along the road between them, and most of their outposts are destroyed. The invasion halts at the walls of Vanderwail. There, Brogar's horde

breaks upon the immense walls, and Lazarus of Duneedin charges out to take the head of Brogard (this trophy is still on display in the Cathedral of St. Lazarus in the town of Deneedin).

- 450-50 **Age of Rebuilding;** Little besides recovering from the destruction of Brogard's invasion happens in this time. (good spot to add in Kez, I think, and his contributions; you seem to have ideas and a plan for this saint, eh?)
- 0 **Conquest of Avitus;** Called Gulfziam by the Ferals at this time, the modern day city of Avitus is defeated under the leadership of Saint Abaddon, and has not been retaken to this day, despite many more years of conflict and sieges to come. With the conquest of this city, which for over 1000 years had been the prime objective of the Empire, the Imperial Calendar was begun. It was started a number of times before that, but only after Abaddon's conquest of the City has it remained in the hands of Men.
- 0-745 **Second Age of Imperial Expansion;** During this long stretch of time, during which much happened, the Empire experiences it's greatest amount of growth and expansion. Several colonies are founded over seas, as well as many west of the Barrier Wood. This is, in great part, due to the study of New Magic, by those exploring the ruins of Waldheim. This age is also known as the **Age of New Magic**, though by none but the most academic. The bulk of the magical artifacts in the world are created at this time, when mages and alchemists were given the freedom to pursue their studies. Countless Crusades are launched at this time. During this time, the citizens of the Empire are speaking the 'Old Imperial' tongue, which has been developing slowly since Sebald set foot on the continent. This language was added to even more by Ignatius of Gamelton (-44-65), who uncovered many secrets of the Elders.
- 333 In this year, a meteor shower lasting 11 nights has the Empire in chaos. Most people believe that the end might be near, despite the growth of the Empire. A very opportunistic Scion of Rivenghast uses this coincidence to further his own aims. This man, Lothar the Unifier (301-389), claims to have been visited by Saint Rivenghast during each night of the Meteor Shower, which he explains off as being a great flight of Angels into Hell, to wage war.
- Lothar also explains that the Celestial name for Rivenghast is Avitus, and has every bit of evidence of the name 'Rivenghast' taken from society. The church itself, and the city of Abaddon are renamed 'Avitus' in honour of this discovery. An era of unmatched Ecclesiastical Authority commences from here, as Lothar develops the first true beaurocracies.

745-1023 **First Inquisition;** With the Crusades leaving the Empire all-but empty of troops, and bringing back with them strange languages, goods and culture, the **Black Faith** erupts from the shadows of the empire. This is an age of terrible crimes on behalf of both inquisitors and demon- and devil-worshipping cults alike. The expansion of the Empire halts during this time. Troops are called home, and the foreign colonies slowly begin to loose contact with the Empire. This period is marked, at its beginning, by the famous public decree of Nicetus Avitus Vanderwail (700-804) in the Capital, known as the "Prospectus Imperialis ex Daemonica". This very heavy-handed policy of rooting out evil led to the terrible crimes for which the Inquisition is usually associated to and feared for.

This period is marked, at its end, by the renouncing of the Inquisitorial Authority by Maiolus the Forgiving (960-1074), who is known as the most benign ruler the Empire ever had. This came after the burning of the entire village of Hamstonfast on 31 October, 1023, and the death of every one of its 900 citizens.